

NOIR

EGGLESS BROWN BUTTER SABLÉ
DARK CHOCOLATE & WHITE MISO GANACHE

Yield	Approx. 24–28 sandwich biscuits	**Shell**	4–4.5 cm; 5 mm thick
Active prep	45–55 minutes	**Resting**	1 hour + 10–15 min after cutting
Baking	12–15 min per tray	**Oven**	160°C conventional / 150°C fan

Concept: French-inspired sablé biscuits with a delicate short crumb, nutty brown butter and toasted milk, balanced by one uniform dark chocolate–white miso ganache. White miso is fully incorporated into the chocolate filling. There is **no white cream and no second filling**.

Yield note: Actual count depends on cutter size, dough thickness and trimming. Pipe approximately 8–10 g ganache per sandwich.

1. Ingredients

A. Brown butter sablé shells

Ingredient	Quantity	Technical note
Unsalted butter, for browning	220 g	Start here; weigh out 180 g cooled brown butter for the dough.
Icing sugar, sifted	75 g	Fine texture.
Plain flour	230 g	Weigh accurately.
Cornflour	35 g	Creates tenderness.
Skimmed milk powder	25 g	For the dough.
Skimmed milk powder, extra	15 g	Toast separately; never add to the butter pan.
Vanilla bean paste	5 g	Or good vanilla extract.
Fine sea salt	2 g	Adjust only if butter is salted.
Ground green cardamom	0.5 g	Subtle background note.
Cold cream	10–20 g, only if needed	Add 5 g at a time only if dough will not bind.

B. Single dark chocolate–white miso ganache

Ingredient	Quantity	Technical note
Dark couverture chocolate, 64–70%	150 g	Finely chop.
Heavy cream, 30–35% fat	100 g	Heat until steaming; do not boil hard.
Unsalted butter	15 g	Softened.
White miso paste	8 g	Use mild white miso; smooth any lumps.
Fine sea salt	Only if needed	Taste first; miso contributes salt.

C. Finish

40 g finely chopped roasted pistachios for the exposed ganache edge. Optional edible gold leaf or a few flakes of sea salt. These are finishing elements, not extra fillings.

2. Equipment

- Light-coloured saucepan, heatproof spatula and heatproof bowl for browning butter.
- Small dry frying pan and spatula for toasting milk powder.
- Digital scale, mixing bowl, sieve, baking parchment and rolling pin.
- 4–4.5 cm round cutter, flat baking trays and cooling rack.
- Heatproof bowl, spatula or small whisk, piping bag and plain round nozzle.

3. Method — Sablé shells

Step 1 — Make the brown butter (beurre noisette)

- Cut 220 g unsalted butter into even pieces and place in a clean, light-coloured saucepan. Heat over medium-low until melted.
- The butter foams as its water evaporates. Stir gently and watch the milk solids at the bottom. They progress from pale to golden brown while the butter develops a nutty aroma.
- Remove from the heat when the solids are deep golden and the liquid is amber. Do not let the solids turn dark brown or black.
- Pour the butter, including all browned solids, into a heatproof bowl. Cool until soft and opaque, not liquid. Weigh exactly 180 g for the dough. If the yield is short, make up the difference with softened unsalted butter; do not use extra liquid brown butter.

Technique note: the flavour comes from browning the milk solids, not simply melting or overheating the fat. A light-coloured pan makes the solids easier to monitor.

Step 2 — Toast the milk powder separately

- Place the additional 15 g skimmed milk powder in a clean, dry frying pan over low heat.
- Stir continuously until pale golden and fragrant. It should remain dry and powdery; do not let it become dark or bitter.
- Immediately transfer to a cool plate and let it cool completely. Keep it separate from the brown butter.

Step 3 — Mix the butter base

- Place 180 g cooled, soft brown butter in a mixing bowl. Add 75 g sifted icing sugar.
- Mix with a spatula until smooth and cohesive. Do not whip to a fluffy buttercream; excessive air can encourage spreading.
- Mix in 5 g vanilla bean paste, 2 g fine sea salt and 0.5 g ground cardamom.

Step 4 — Add dry ingredients

- Sift or whisk together 230 g plain flour, 35 g cornflour, 25 g skimmed milk powder and all 15 g cooled toasted milk powder.
- Add the dry mixture to the butter base in two or three additions. Fold until it resembles damp crumbs and begins to clump.
- Bring together with minimal handling. If it will not hold when pressed, add cold cream 5 g at a time, using only what is necessary (10–20 g maximum). Stop as soon as it binds. Do not knead.

Step 5 — Roll and rest

- Divide into two portions. Place each between two sheets of baking parchment.
- Roll evenly to 5 mm thickness, checking centre and edges for uniformity.
- Keep the sheets flat and refrigerate for 1 hour. This firms the butter and makes clean cutting easier.

Step 6 — Cut and chill

- Peel away the upper parchment. Cut 4–4.5 cm rounds with a sharp metal cutter, pressing straight down without twisting.
- Lift carefully with a small offset spatula and place on a parchment-lined tray, leaving about 2 cm between rounds.
- Re-roll scraps only once, keeping the dough cool. Chill cut rounds for another 10–15 minutes before baking.

Step 7 — Bake

- Preheat to 160°C conventional or 150°C fan-assisted. Use an oven thermometer if available.
- Bake for 12–15 minutes, rotating only if your oven has uneven hot spots. The biscuits should remain pale gold with slightly deeper edges; avoid dark browning.
- Cool on the tray for 5 minutes, then transfer carefully to a rack. Cool completely before filling.

4. Method — Dark chocolate and white miso ganache

Recipe identity: this is one homogeneous dark chocolate ganache. White miso is a seasoning incorporated into that ganache; it is not a separate cream and must not create a second-colour layer.

- Finely chop 150 g dark couverture chocolate and place in a clean, dry heatproof bowl.
- Heat 100 g cream until steaming, with small bubbles around the edge. Do not boil vigorously.
- Pour the hot cream evenly over the chocolate. Leave undisturbed for 60–90 seconds so the chocolate begins to melt.
- Starting in the centre, stir slowly with a spatula in small circles. Gradually widen the circles as the glossy emulsion forms. Avoid whisking in air.
- Add 8 g white miso paste and mix until no streaks remain. Add 15 g softened butter and stir until completely incorporated and glossy.
- Optional: use an immersion blender with its head fully submerged to refine the emulsion and avoid bubbles.
- Cover the surface directly with cling film. Cool until thick, smooth and pipeable. If too fluid, allow more cooling; do not add extra chocolate without recalculating the formula.

5. Assembly

- Pair completely cooled shells by matching their sizes and shapes.
- Transfer the pipeable ganache to a piping bag fitted with a plain round nozzle.
- Pipe approximately 8–10 g ganache onto the flat side of one shell, leaving a narrow border.
- Place a second shell on top, flat side towards the filling. Press gently and evenly until the ganache reaches close to the edge. Do not squeeze so hard that the shells crack.
- Roll only the exposed dark ganache edge through finely chopped roasted pistachios. The cross-section must show two golden biscuits and exactly one dark chocolate ganache layer.
- Set briefly in a cool place until stable. Serve at cool room temperature for the best butter aroma and ganache texture.

6. Troubleshooting and quality control

Issue	Likely cause	Correction
Butter tastes burnt	Milk solids became too dark.	Use medium-low heat and remove as soon as solids are deep golden; restart if bitter.
Dough is greasy or too soft	Brown butter was warm or liquid.	Cool until soft and opaque; chill dough before rolling.
Dough cracks while rolling	It is too cold or under-hydrated.	Let it stand briefly. If still crumbly, work in a few grams of cream.
Biscuits lose their shape	Dough warmed before baking or butter was over-aerated.	Chill cut rounds and avoid whipping the butter base.
Biscuits are tough	Dough was overworked or baked too long.	Fold only until combined; bake to pale-golden edges.
Ganache is split or oily	Emulsion was unstable or butter was added too hot.	Stir from the centre slowly; add butter after emulsion forms. Blend submerged if needed.
Ganache is too soft	It has not cooled sufficiently.	Allow it to thicken at room temperature before piping.
A white layer appears	An unintended second filling has been introduced.	Use only the single dark chocolate–miso ganache. No white chocolate or cream filling.

7. Storage and service

- Unfilled, fully cooled shells: store airtight in a cool, dry place for approximately 7–10 days, subject to humidity and handling.
- Ganache: refrigerate sealed and use within approximately 5 days. Bring to a workable consistency before piping.
- Assembled biscuits: store airtight in the refrigerator and aim to consume within 3–4 days. Allow to temper briefly before serving.
- For commercial sale, validate shelf life under the actual recipe, packaging, handling and storage conditions. These are practical kitchen guidelines, not a validated food-safety study.

8. Chef’s final checklist

- Brown butter is amber and nutty, with golden milk solids retained.

- Toasted milk powder is prepared separately and cooled before use.
- Dough is handled minimally and rolled to a consistent 5 mm.
- Shells are pale golden, fully cooled and crisp before filling.
- Ganache is one smooth dark chocolate emulsion with white miso fully incorporated.
- Every sandwich contains two sablé shells and one dark ganache layer only.

THE CURLY CHEF — NOIR. A little dark. A little delicate. Entirely irresistible.